



PHOTO BY MANDAR DEODHAR

EMBRACING CHANGE IIMA is taking a relook at case studies, using technology to give students shorter print versions

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Interestingly, five students opted for the IIMAvericks fellowship, under which the school will mentor and support them financially for two years to set up entrepreneurial ventures.

The innovative “Dream Application” policy, which empowers students to pursue their preferred sectors and roles, continued to be a highlight of the process, with 132 such applications recorded during the placement season.

One of the most important ways through which IIMA is looking to create leaders who can thrive in an uncertain environment is to enhance the quality of its engagements with industry. Traditionally, this was done through summer internship and the placement process.

For example, its intensive faculty development programmes seek to update them with knowledge

of the new technologies. Further, the institution is focusing more on executive education programmes and consulting by the faculty to understand better the challenges that companies are facing and transfer that knowledge to the students.

CHANGES AFOOT

The impact of the changing environment in India and abroad is evident on IIMA. A pioneer of the two-year MBA, it has started its Dubai campus with a one-year MBA. The rationale was that there is an urgent need for good managerial talent there and, therefore, the sooner students get a degree the faster they will be able to get jobs. IIMA is also taking a relook at its well-regarded case studies, which typically used to run into about 30-40 pages. Now, with immersive technologies, students will be able

to absorb cases in depth in a shorter print version of, say, 10 pages.

The Common Admission Test, which all the IIMs and many other private business schools use to select the students, could be less preferred in the future because of the intense competition that it generates. Many B-schools and students now prefer GRE or GMAT. Competition in the market will also grow because foreign higher education institutions are slowly coming to India. Others have their presence in India online and physically especially in the shorter executive education programmes, the growth of private sector-backed business schools and the setting up of multiple campuses.

So, even as IIMA is the highest ranked B-school in this year’s BT-MDRA survey, it has its work cut out for the coming years. **BT**